



Get qualified to assure Quality

With cutting edge software constantly running on all kinds of machines, many talented youngsters are scrambling to get a toehold in the lucrative segment of IT industry, which deals with testing of software and analysing its quality.

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When Sanjay Prakash began working at a reputed Bangalore based software company, his department head advised him to take a Spanish language course that was being taught on the company's campus. Within few weeks he found himself debugging software written for the Spanish market, and realised how important it is for a professional to learn the nitty-gritties of the language. Before joining his job, Prakash had taken a Computer Science degree from a reputed university. He has also successfully taken a certification in software testing, and now is also learning Spanish, to further enhance his capabilities in debugging software written for Spanish market.

Professionals working in Software Quality Assurance departments of IT

companies play a very crucial role. If software has not been tested adequately, then it can lead to delays and cost overruns – something that companies cannot afford in a time of heightened competition. It is the job of Software Quality Assurance engineers to ensure that the software is free of bugs when it released. Typically, almost 40 per cent of software professionals employed in any company work on Software Quality Assurance. After joining a company, the selected candidates have to undergo intensive training on technologies and tools that the company wants them to use during the testing process. After completing the training period, they are allowed to take up live projects. Testing and verification is done manually or through an automated process.

Work for top corporations

When we think of information technology, we automatically start thinking

of the creators of software. We tend to forget the middlemen who perform the crucial job of testing the software before it gets shipped to the user. These middlemen are those who comprise the Software Quality Assurance team. Often Software Quality Assurance is confused merely with Software testing, but that is not the case. Software testing comprises only a small part of all the processes that come under Software Quality Assurance. During the entire process of the development of software, the Software Quality Assurance Engineer has to be involved in order to ensure that the final product is of high standard. The job may entail tasks such as gathering and documentation, source code control, code review, change management, configuration management, release management and finally the actual testing of the software.

Any reputed company will prefer to have a Software Quality Assurance Engineer who has a Computer Science or similar degree. But along with that some specific certifications are also required. When a fresh individual joins a large company in the Software QA department, he has to pass through an extensive period of training during which he might also have to take relevant certification from a reputed International agency. The most notable certifications in this field are those that are being offered by QAI (Quality Assurance Institute) and by ISTQB. The company, where the individual is employed, typically pays the examination fees for these certifications. The exam consists of multiple-choice questions and in most cases is over in around an hour. Along with the degree and certifications, a Software QA engineer is also expected to have good communication and networking skills. He should be good at documenting his work.

If your resume is embellished with a Computer Science degree from a reputed institute and a latest certification, then you will have no difficulty in getting a suitable position in any top multi-national like Adobe, Infosys, TCS, Wipro, IBM, HCL and others. For instance, Adobe India is operating a